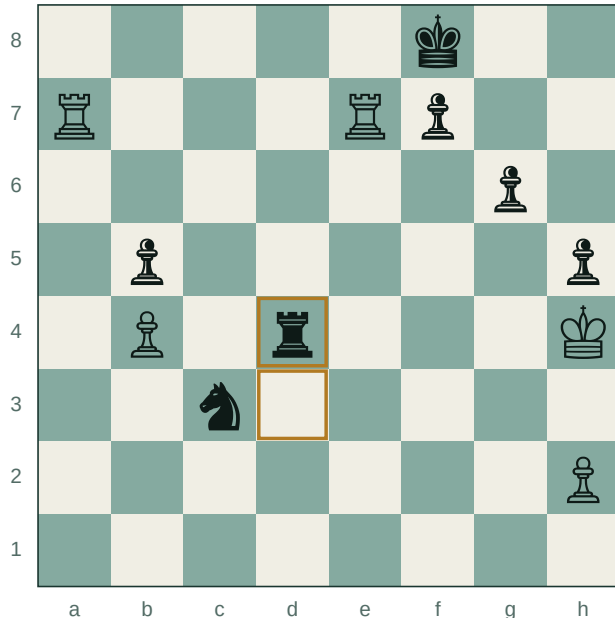


Active defensive resources: White, move 44

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 43...Rd4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44. Kg5 Ne4+ 45. Kh6

44.Kg5 The king moves from h4 to g5. Recorded reply: **44...Ne4+**.

45.Kh6 The king moves from g5 to h6.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: rook on d4 and knight on c3. Check for tactical protection.